Shearing:- The hair or fur of the sheep is removed from its body. This is called shearing.

Grading (or) Sorting:- The fleece from the same sheep may be different from different parts of the body. It is sorted out into separate piles of similar nature. This is known as Grading (or) Sorting.

Washing (or) Scouting:- The sheared skin is washed thoroughly with soap (or) detergents to remove dirt, dust and grease.

Carding:- The dried wool is carefully removed. These fibres then passed through the rollers which are covered with fine sheet of thin wire teeth. This process arranges the wool into a flat sheet called a web.

Spinning:- The web is drawn into narrow strand and then passed through spinning machines. The spinning machines twist the strands into yarn. The yarn is wound to form balls of wool. This yarn is either weaved into fabric (or) retained for knitting.

Characteristic features of wool

- ❖ It is resistant to heat, water, wear and tear.
- ❖ It absorbs moisture.
- ❖ Wool insulates against cold. So wool is a good insulator.
- ❖ It does not wrinkle easily.

Uses of wool

Wool is a multifunctional fibre with a range of diameters that makes it suitable for clothing, household fabrics and technical textiles. Two third of wool is used in the manufacture of garments including sweaters, dresses, coats and active sportswear. Blended with other natural (or) synthetic fibres wool used as adds drape and crease resistance blankets, anti-static and noise absorbing carpets.

Silk

Have you ever attended marriage functions? What type of dresses the bride and bridegroom wear? What is it made up of?

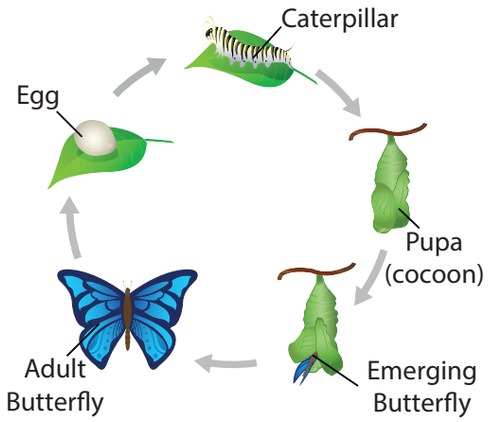


Silk is the secretions of the silk moth. Silk is obtained from the cocoon of silk worms, which feed on the mulberry leaves. Silk worms live for a very short time, only about two months. During this period they pass through four stages of development. They are eggs, caterpillars, cocoon and adult moth. These stages are called as life cycle of a silk worm.

The cultivation and production of silk is known as Sericulture. An adult female silk moth lays about 500 eggs. The eggs are then kept in cold storage for six weeks. The eggs are placed in the incubator. After about ten days, the eggs hatch out and the larvae spend the next 35 days eating mulberry leaves.

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Life cycle of butterfly



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